Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI-based fraud is a growing form of cybercrime in which scammers trick individuals into transferring money or sharing sensitive information. With the increasing use of digital payment applications, such cases have become more common, especially among students and people who are new to online transactions.

In a typical scenario, a person may receive a call or message from someone pretending to be a bank official or customer support representative. The scammer often creates urgency by claiming that there is an issue with the user's account or by offering fake rewards and cashback. They then try to convince the person to click on a suspicious

link, share their OTP, or approve a payment request through their UPI application.

Many people fall victim to such frauds due to lack of awareness or panic created by the scammer. Without verifying the authenticity of the request, the victim may unknowingly follow the instructions given to them.

As a result, money gets deducted instantly from the victim’s bank account without their consent. Recovering the lost amount can be difficult, leading to financial loss and mental stress. This situation highlights the importance of staying alert and being cautious while using digital payment platforms.

🛡️ Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

- Do not share your OTP, passwords, or UPI PIN with anyone, even if they claim to be from a bank
- Always double-check payment requests before approving them on your phone
- Be careful while clicking links received through unknown messages or emails
- Use only trusted and official apps for making online payments
- Turn on two-factor authentication to add an extra layer of security
- Keep an eye on your bank transactions to quickly notice anything unusual
- Avoid accepting UPI requests from people you do not know *(UPI specific)*

- Remember that UPI PIN is required only when you send money, not when you receive it *(UPI specific)*
- If you face any online fraud, report it immediately on the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)
- You can also call the helpline number **1930** for quick help and support